Untimely

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Manuscript excerpt

Chapter 1: A Wedding, Then a Wreck

May 25, 2024, was a day full of joy...

May 25, 2024, was a day full of joy, chaos, and the nervous energy that surrounds any wedding. My wife and I were in full motion, busy with last-minute preparations for our son's big day. We were praying everything would go smoothly—asking God for calm, for beauty, and for a blessing over the day. Our daughters were radiant, all of them serving as bridesmaids. My youngest daughter and I shared a moment I'll never forget—we had the privilege of singing and playing together for the procession and during the lighting of the unity candle. The atmosphere was sacred, wrapped in celebration, laughter, and love.

It was one of those moments you want to freeze in time.

But time doesn't freeze.

Barely three weeks later, on June 13, 2024, at approximately 2:30 in the morning, we received the kind of news that every parent prays they never will.

Our beautiful daughter Loren, and her best friend Camille, were killed in a horrific head-on collision.

In the blink of an eye, our world was shattered.

There are no words for that kind of moment—just the sound of silence in your soul as everything caves in. There's shock. Then anguish. Then something deeper that has no name. The mind refuses to catch up to what the heart already knows. Death has a sound. And we heard it that night.

We had just celebrated the wedding of our son—our family beaming with joy—and now we were planning a funeral. The contrast was surreal. I remember the stillness. I remember the air felt different, heavier. And I remember thinking, How can this be real?

But somehow, in the quiet horror of that moment, I also knew this: God was still with us.

It didn't make sense—not to the natural mind. But something deep in my spirit whispered, What feels so untimely to us is not untimely to God.

And that's what this story is about.

This is not a story of how strong we are. It's a story of how gracious God is. Of how He walks into the ruins, unafraid. Of how He holds you while you scream. Of how He whispers to your broken heart, Keep running this race—you don't know where the finish line is.

That line stayed with me.

In the days that followed, it became a lifeline. When I didn't know how to stand, those words helped me kneel. When I couldn't speak, they helped me weep. God reminded me that we

don’t have to do this in our own strength or might—but by His Spirit.

Even in the days of deepest sorrow, I began to see something impossible: a gift. Not the kind we ask for. Not the kind anyone wants. But a gift, nonetheless.

Because sometimes—if you can receive it—God entrusts you with something so sacred, so weighty, so wrapped in His presence, that it changes you forever. Not because it’s easy, but because it’s holy. And this gift… this sorrow… was sacred.

We didn’t deserve it. We didn’t ask for it. But we were chosen to carry it.

And through it all, God never left our side.

Chapter 2: When Heaven Weeps With You

June 21, 2024. The day of Loren’s memorial...

The day of Loren’s memorial service arrived like a thundercloud—looming, heavy, and hard to breathe under. There was a weight in the air I couldn’t shake. I spent most of the day wrestling with grief, anger, and a fog so thick I could barely concentrate.

We had just learned that the driver who caused the wreck—a man with two prior DWIs—was intoxicated again. He had stolen something priceless from two families, from our church, and from a community who adored these girls. And yet, in the chaos of justice and loss, we found a strange peace rising from the ashes.